

How to turn cold Instagram DMs into booked calls

Welcome to MagnetEngine. This playbook covers the psychology behind every message you approve in your queue. Read it once before your first campaign, then keep it open while reviewing DMs.

■ THE ONE RULE

Nobody buys from a first message. The only job of DM #1 is to earn a reply. The only job of the replies that follow is to earn a call. The close happens on the call — never in the DM.

DM → Reply → Short Conversation → Booked Call → Close (on the call)

If a message in your approval queue tries to skip a step — pitching the offer, dropping a price, pasting a link in message #1 — **reject it or edit it back.**

■ WHY PEOPLE REPLY: 6 PRINCIPLES

The first thing a stranger's brain asks is "*why is this person messaging ME?*" If the answer is "they're blasting everyone," you're archived. The opener must contain one detail that could only be about **them** — their bio, niche, city, or content.

■ **Weak:** "Hey! Love your page ■"

■ **Strong:** "Hey Sara — saw you run online fitness coaching for new moms, that postpartum angle is smart."

■ **Pro Tip:** When editing DMs in your queue, protect the personalized line. It's the highest-value sentence in the entire message.

People reply to close open loops. Hint at a specific result without explaining the mechanism — the explanation is what the call is for.

■ **Weak:** "We help coaches get more clients with our proven system."

■ **Strong:** "We helped another coach in your niche add 9 booked calls last month without posting more content — different approach than what you're probably doing."

■ **Pro Tip:** Specific numbers (9 calls, 23 replies, 14 days) are more believable than round ones and open a stronger loop.

A micro-gift in the first exchange (a genuine observation, a quick tip, a relevant resource) creates a small social debt. It doesn't need to be big — it needs to be **real**. Fake compliments register as spam instantly.

Proof works when it's *proximate*: same niche, same size, same city. "We work with 500 businesses" is noise. "We work with two other real-estate agents in Miami" is signal. Keep one proximate proof line ready per niche you target.

Big asks get ignored. Tiny asks get answered. End DM #1 with a question that costs almost nothing to answer — a yes/no or a one-word answer. Each small "yes" makes the next bigger ask (the call) feel consistent.

■ **Weak CTA:** "Want to hop on a call this week?" (too big, too soon)

■ **Strong CTA:** "Mind if I send over a quick idea?" / "Are you taking on new clients right now?" / "Worth a shot in your business?"

People move to avoid missing out more than to gain. Frame around what's slipping past them ("most coaches lose the lead in the first 24h of silence"). **Never fake scarcity** ("only 2 spots left!!"). Use one loss-framed line per *sequence*, not per message.

ANATOMY OF A HIGH-REPLY DM

Three sentences. Under ~40 words. No links. No price. One question mark.

Line	Job	Psychology
1. Personal hook	Answer "why me?"	Relevance
2. Value hint	Open the loop	Curiosity + proof
3. Micro-ask	Make replying effortless	Yes-ladder

> Hey Sara — saw you coach new moms through postpartum fitness, love that niche. We helped another mom-focused coach add 9 booked calls last month without extra content. Open to hearing how?

- Contains one detail specific to this lead (not swappable to anyone else)
- No link, no price, no "book here" in message #1
- Under ~40 words, reads like a human typed it on their phone
- Ends with a low-effort question
- Tone matches your brand voice (set in Settings → AI Prompt Wizard)

■ WHEN THEY REPLY: SPEED, TRIAGE & THE CALL ASK

Reply within the hour whenever possible. Response interest decays fast — a warm reply left overnight is a cold lead again. **Block 15 minutes daily on your calendar** to check replies and your approval queue.

Log the sentiment in your CRM tracker immediately:

■ LANE 1: POSITIVE

→ Answer briefly, then ask for the call within 1–2 messages. Do not keep selling in the DM — every extra message is a chance to lose them.

■ LANE 2: NEUTRAL

→ Be disarming and human. Re-anchor on the personal detail. Restate the value hint in one line. Ask a smaller question.

■ LANE 3: NEGATIVE

→ One graceful exit line. Mark it in the CRM and move on. *"All good — if it ever becomes a priority, you know where I am ■"* A classy exit occasionally reopens the door weeks later.

When interest is confirmed, make booking feel small and concrete:

> "Easiest way is a quick 15–20 min call — I'll walk you through exactly what we'd do for your account. Here's my calendar: [link]. What does your week look like?"

Psychology at work: **Concreteness** ("15–20 min, walk you through"), **Autonomy** ("What does your week look like?" keeps them in control), and the **earned link** — the calendar link only appears *after* they've shown interest.

After they book: Confirm same-day, and send a one-line reminder the morning of the call. No-shows drop dramatically with a personal reminder:

> "Looking forward to 3pm today ■"

■ FOLLOW-UP PSYCHOLOGY

(Where Most of the Money Is)

Most booked calls come from follow-ups, not first messages. People aren't ignoring you — they're busy. Set these in **Follow-Ups** inside MagnetEngine:

Touch	Timing	Angle	Psychology
Follow-up 1	+2–3 days	"Floating this back up" + restate value hint in new words	Mere exposure — familiarity builds trust
Follow-up 2	+4–5 days after FU1	Add something NEW: a result, an insight about their niche, a specific observation about their content	Reciprocity — each touch gives, never just "bumps"
Follow-up 3	+5–7 days after FU2	The breakup: close the loop politely and take the offer away	Loss aversion — takeaways trigger action

> "Last one from me, promise ■ — going to assume growth is handled for now. If that changes, my door's open. Rooting for you either way."

■ **Pro Tip:** The breakup message routinely out-replies every other touch. Never send a naked "bump" or "just following up!" — a follow-up with no new value is a withdrawal, not a deposit.

■ THE DON'TS

(Instant-Archive Triggers)

- Link or calendar drop in message #1
- Price talk in the DMs — price lives on the call
- Walls of text (if it needs scrolling, it needs editing)
- Fake personalization ("love your content!" with zero specifics)
- Pitching the full offer before they've asked a single question
- Arguing with a "no" — exit gracefully, protect the brand
- More than 3 follow-ups — past that you're training them to ignore you
- Sending outside human hours — keep the drip inside 9am–9pm *their* time

■ KNOW YOUR NUMBERS

(And What to Fix)

Your dashboard tracks the funnel; your CRM tracker holds the detail. **Benchmarks for cold IG outreach:**

Metric	Healthy	If You're Below, Fix...
Reply rate	10–20%	The opener: more relevance, tighter hook, better lead filtering
Positive reply rate	30–50% of replies	Targeting: you're reaching the wrong niche or size
Booking rate	20–40% of positive replies	The call ask: asking too late, too big, or not concrete enough
Show-up rate	60–80% of booked	Reminders: confirm same-day + morning-of message

Work ONE number at a time, top of the funnel first. Change one variable per week (opener, audience, or follow-up timing), read the results in the dashboard's 7-day chart, keep the winner.

■ DAILY OPERATING RHYTHM

(30–45 Min/Day)

Task	Frequency	Time
Scrape	2×/week	Campaign → new search → add to queue
Approve	Daily	Review AI DMs, apply the checklist, approve
Send	Auto	Extension drips approved DMs at your configured delay
Reply	Daily	Triage replies, push warm leads to the call
Log	Daily	Update CRM — replied, booked, closed
Review	Weekly	Check funnel numbers, adjust one variable

■ **Pro Tip:** Consistency beats intensity. 20 great DMs a day, every day, out-earns 200 sloppy ones on a random Tuesday.

■ BONUS: THE REPLY BATTLECARD

When they say... → You say...

They Say	You Say
"I'm manually DMing and it's exhausting"	"Same. I was spending 3 hours a day on it so I built something that handles the research and writing — I just approve and send. Want to see what it looks like?"
"I tried a bot and got flagged"	"That's exactly why I built it differently. Real browser, human approval, randomized delays. Zero flags in 6 months. Want a 2-min demo?"
"I don't have time to prospect"	"Built exactly for that. 20 minutes of setup, then you just approve messages and take calls. I can show you my dashboard if you're curious."
"Not interested"	"All good — if it ever becomes a priority, you know where I am. Rooting for you either way ■"

Questions? Reply to any of our emails or bring them to your onboarding call.

— The MagnetEngine Team